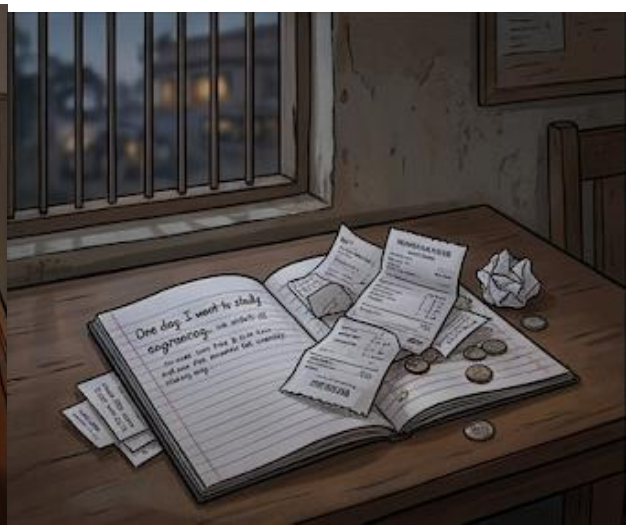
OPENING


One day, I want to study engineering.


Aarav: I want to study engineering


Mother: First, let us see how we manage the next few months



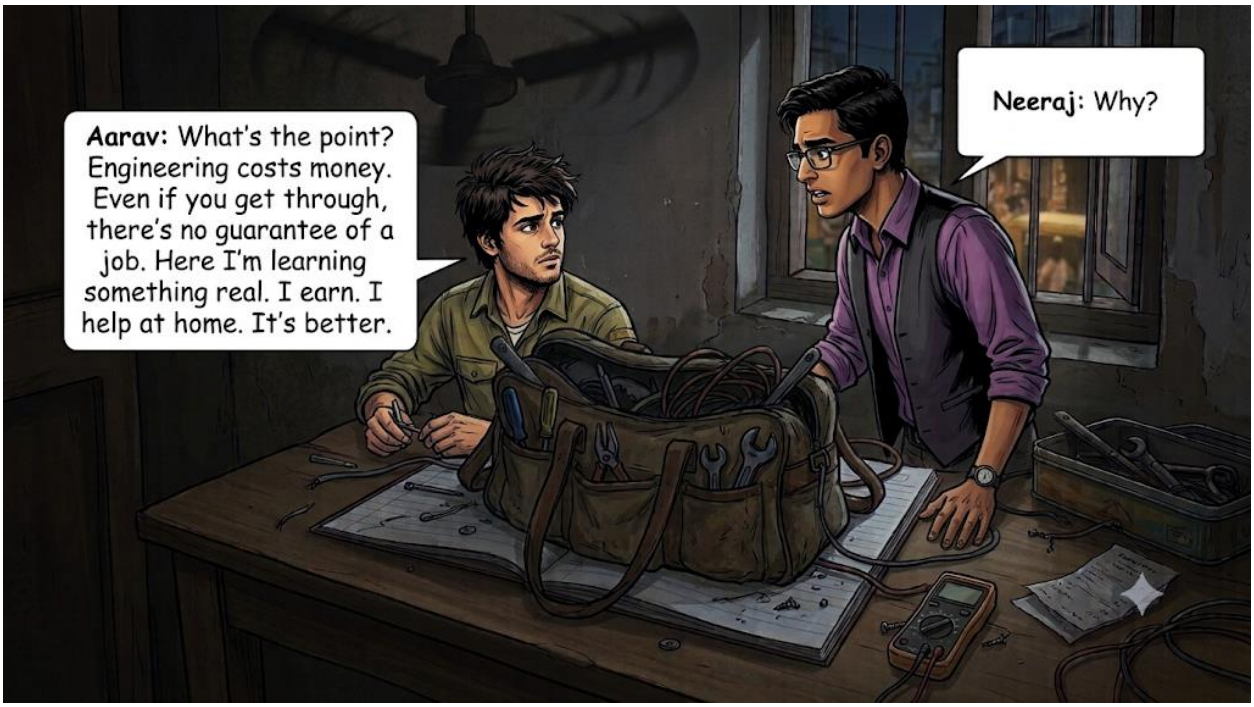



Aarav starts helping at Sharma uncle's electronics repair shop.
He still studies at night. Then less. Then not at all.

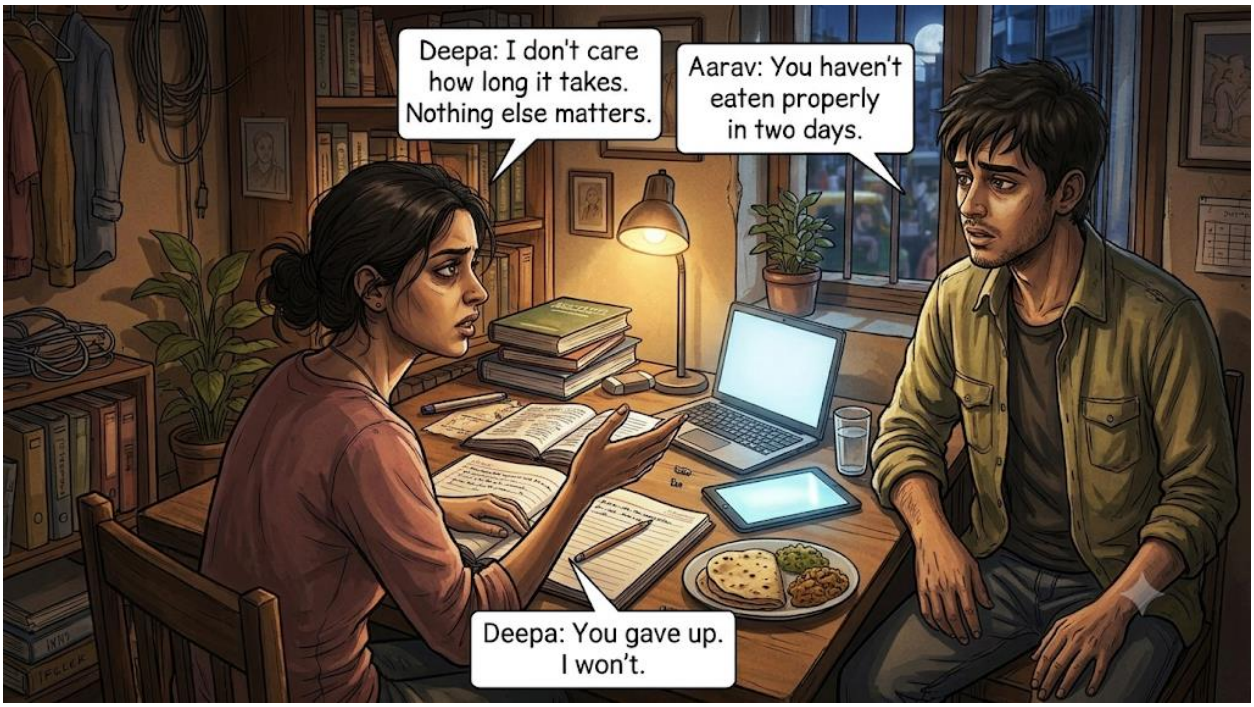
THE LIFE


SIX MONTHS IN


Aarav: No. I've stopped.
Neeraj: Still preparing for the entrance exam?

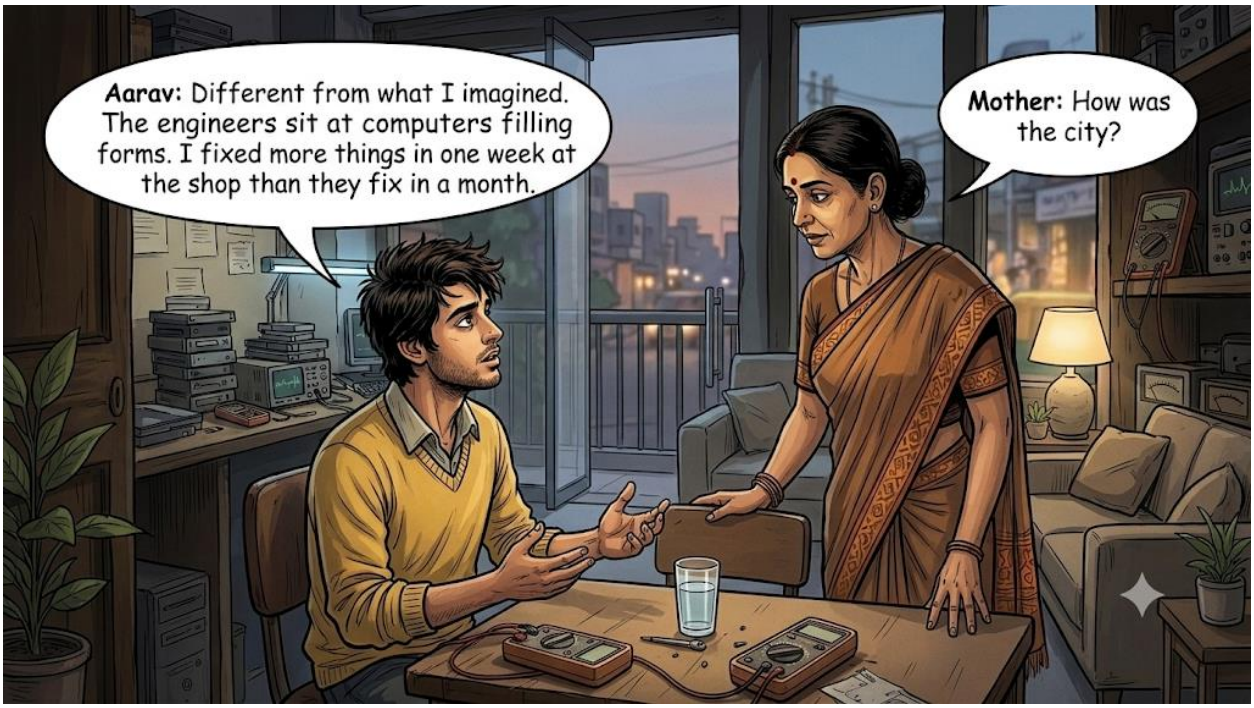

Aarav: What's the point? Engineering costs money. Even if you get through, there's no guarantee of a job. Here I'm learning something real. I earn. I help at home. It's better.
Neeraj: Why?

SAME WEEK


Deepa: I don't care how long it takes. Nothing else matters.
Aarav: You haven't eaten properly in two days.
Deepa: You gave up. I won't.


NINE MONTHS IN



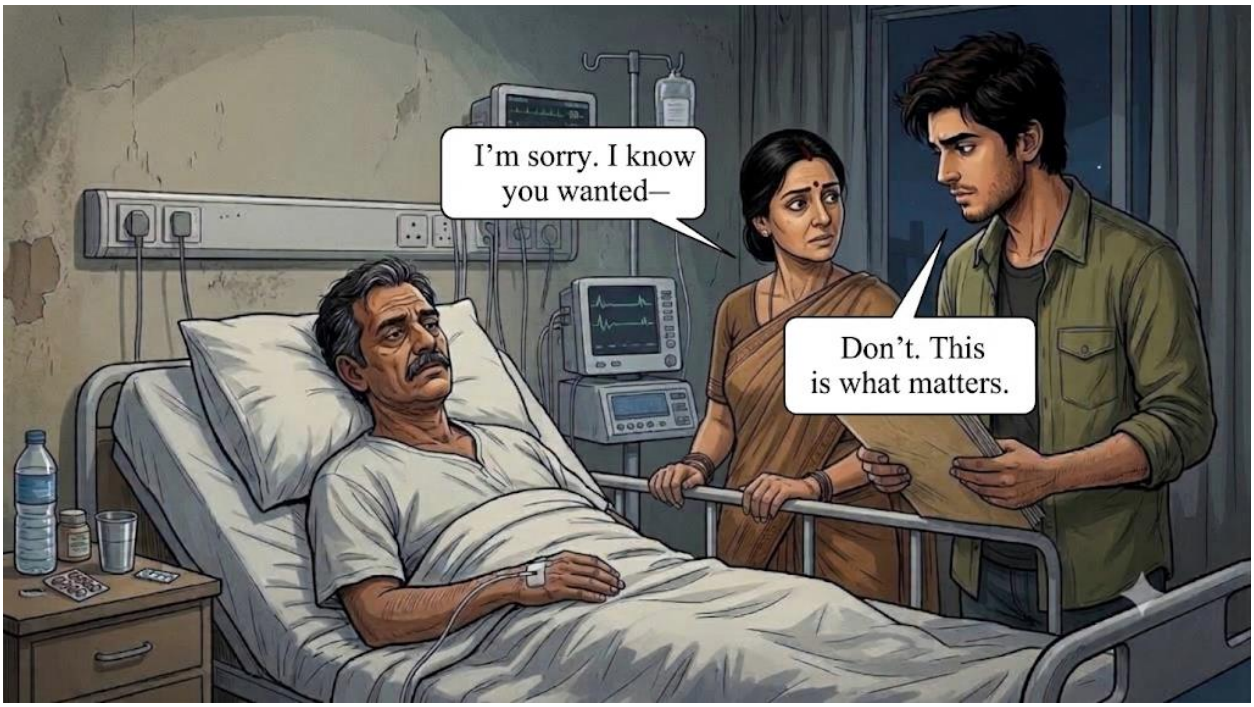

Aarav: Different from what I imagined. The engineers sit at computers filling forms. I fixed more things in one week at the shop than they fix in a month.
Mother: How was the city?


ONE YEAR IN

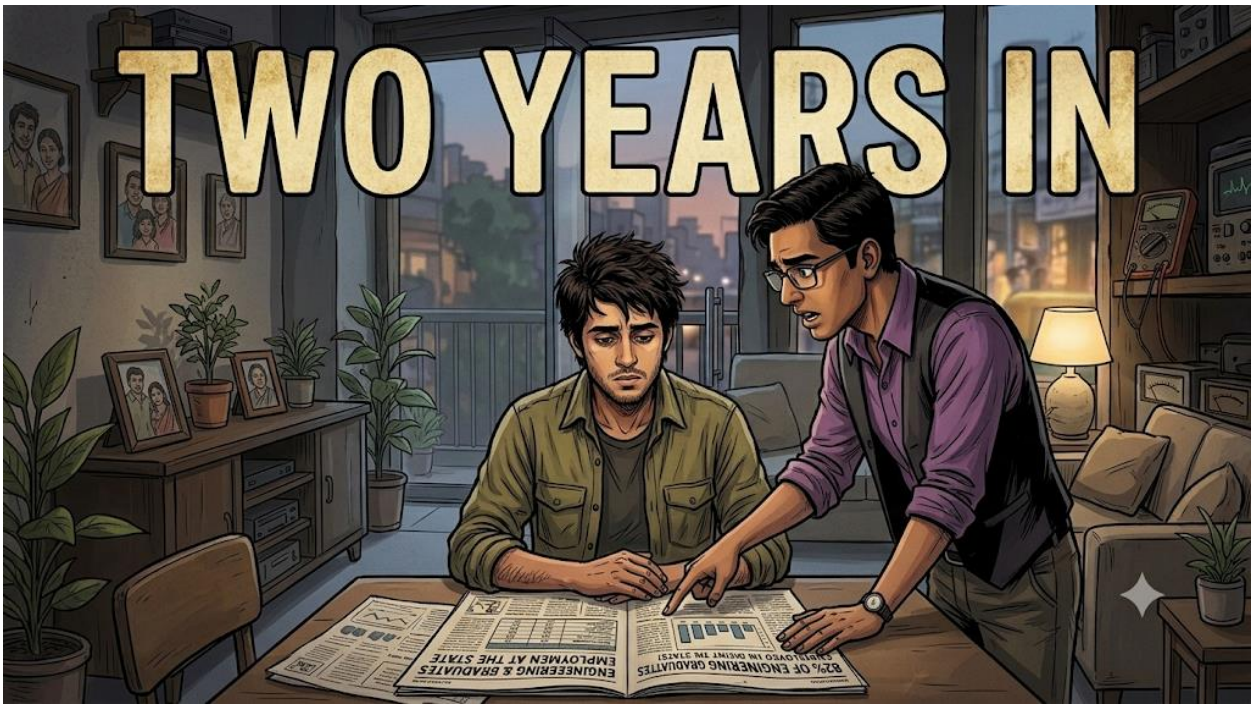

Aarav: If anyone brings me a scholarship form in the next three months, hide it. I need to finish the busy season first. I'll decide in January. Not before.


THIRTEEN MONTHS IN
Sharma: You know, these engineers think they're above us. But who do they come to when their laptops break? Us.
Aarav: That's true.
Sharma: College boys can't hold a screwdriver. Stay here. Five years, I'll make you a partner.


FIFTEEN MONTHS IN
Aarav: I've been thinking. I don't want to spend my life chasing something I may never get. I want to find meaning in what's in front of me. My family. My craft. This neighbourhood.
Neeraj: That sounds like giving up with extra steps.
Aarav: Giving up is when you stop wanting something because it hurts. This is different. I'm choosing what to care about.


I’m sorry. I know you wanted—
Don’t. This is what matters.

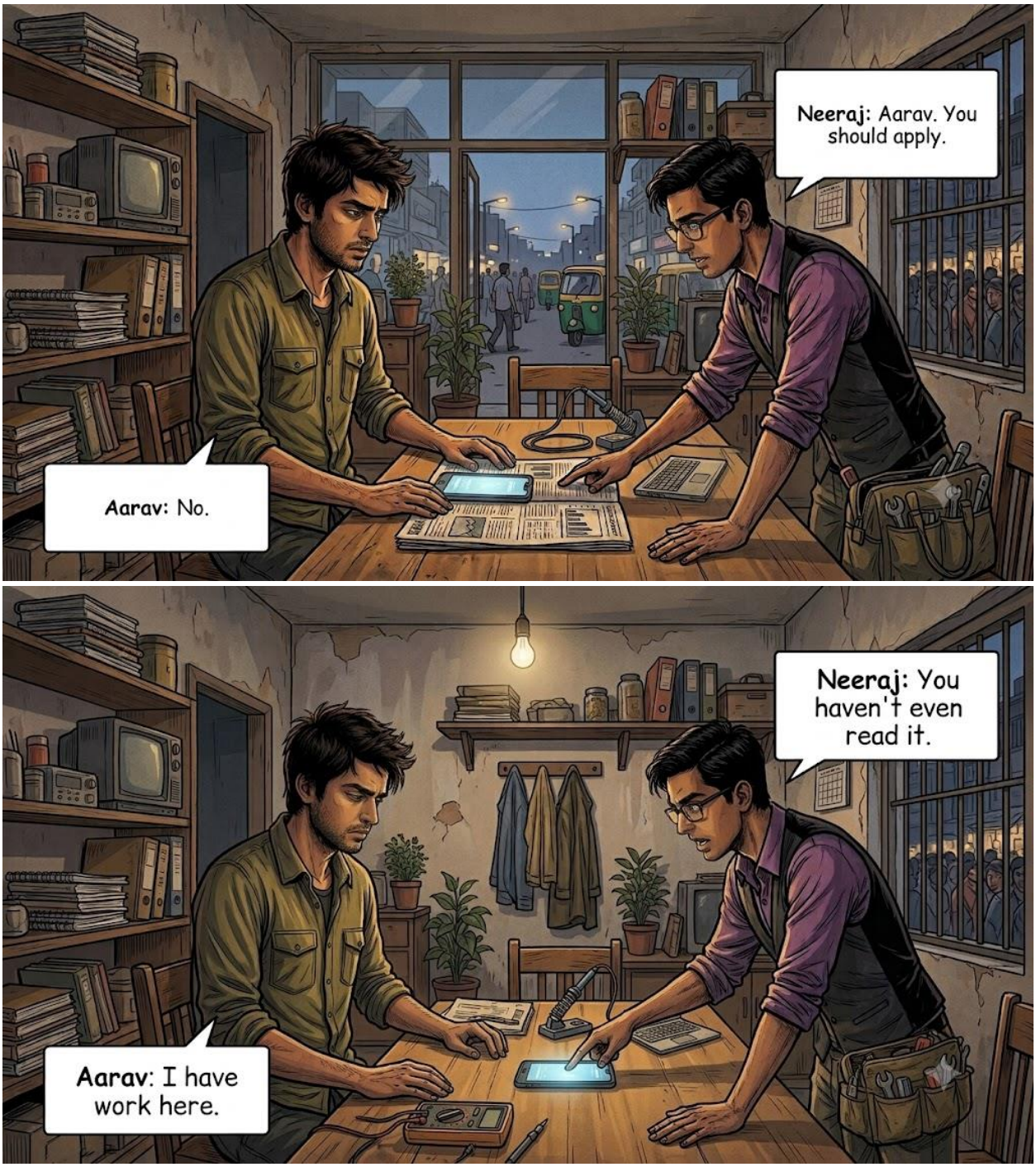

TWENTY MONTHS IN
He used to be the best batsman on the street.

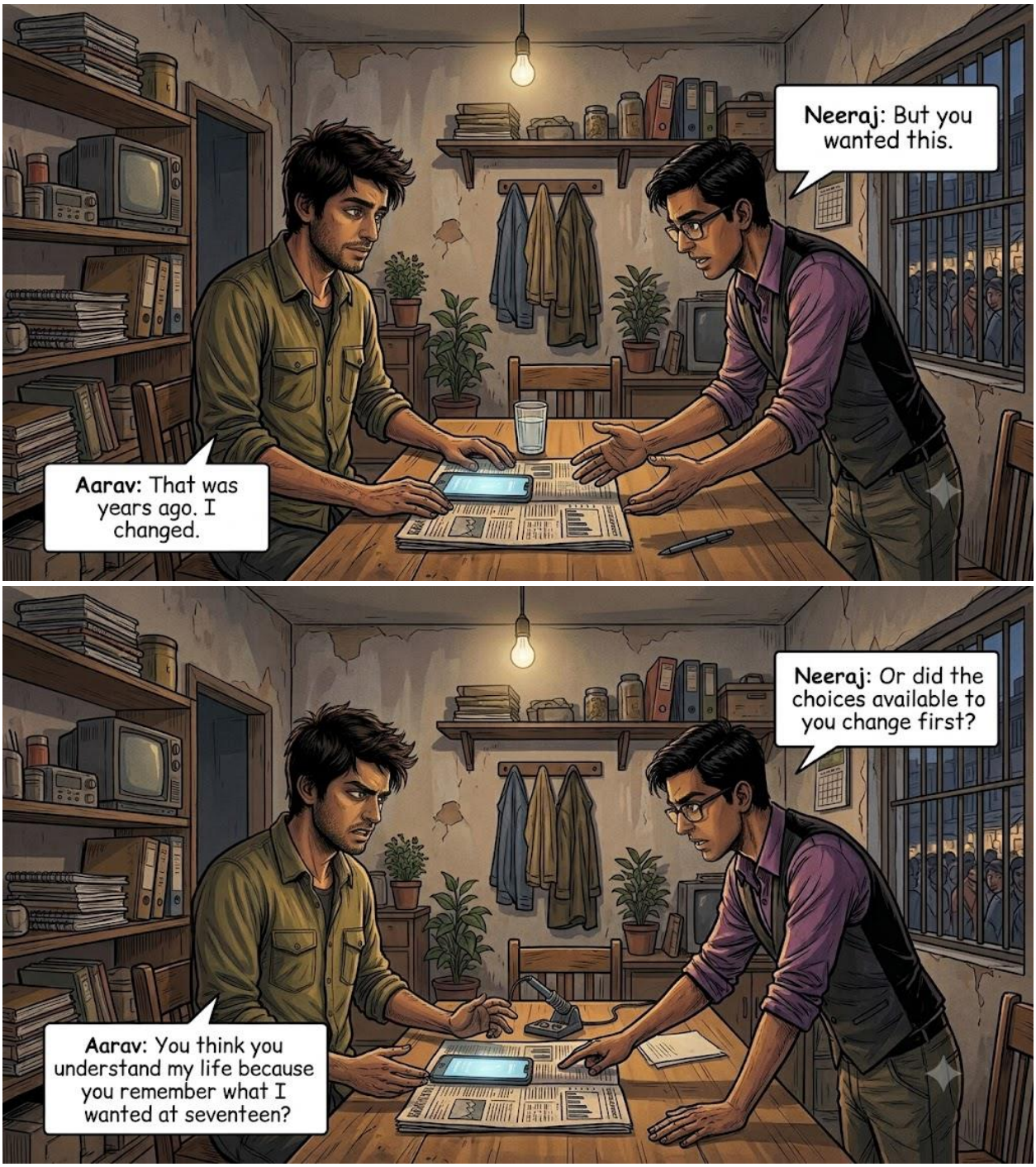

TWO YEARS IN


Aarav: That can't be right. Everyone knows engineers are unemployed.
Neeraj: It says 82%. Look.
Aarav: Newspapers print what they want.
Neeraj: And if money weren't a problem? If someone paid for everything?
Aarav: (long pause) Maybe...
Aarav: But money is a problem. So why think about it?


TWENTY MONTHS IN
Aarav's
Aarav's Taxi



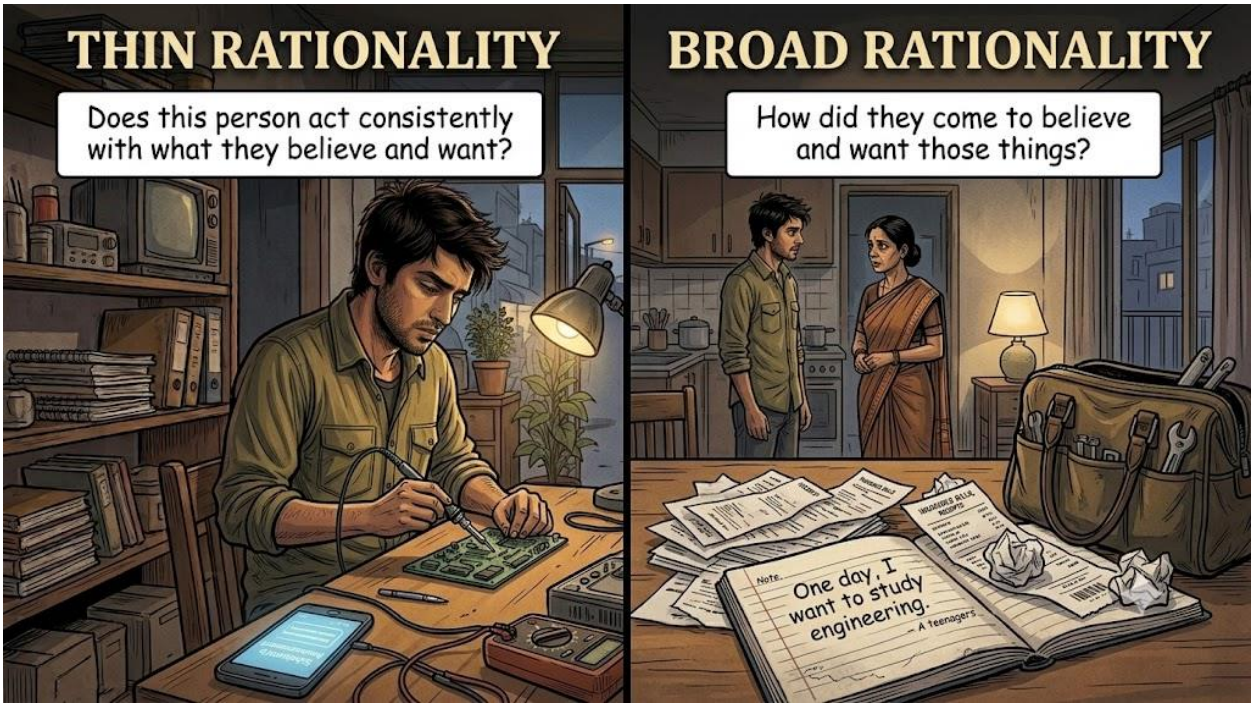

Neeraj: Aarav. You should apply.
Aarav: No.
Neeraj: You haven't even read it.
Aarav: I have work here.


Neeraj: But you wanted this.
Aarav: That was years ago. I changed.
Neeraj: Or did the choices available to you change first?
Aarav: You think you understand my life because you remember what I wanted at seventeen?


Neeraj: I'm not deciding for you. I'm asking.
Aarav: Then ask without already knowing the answer.

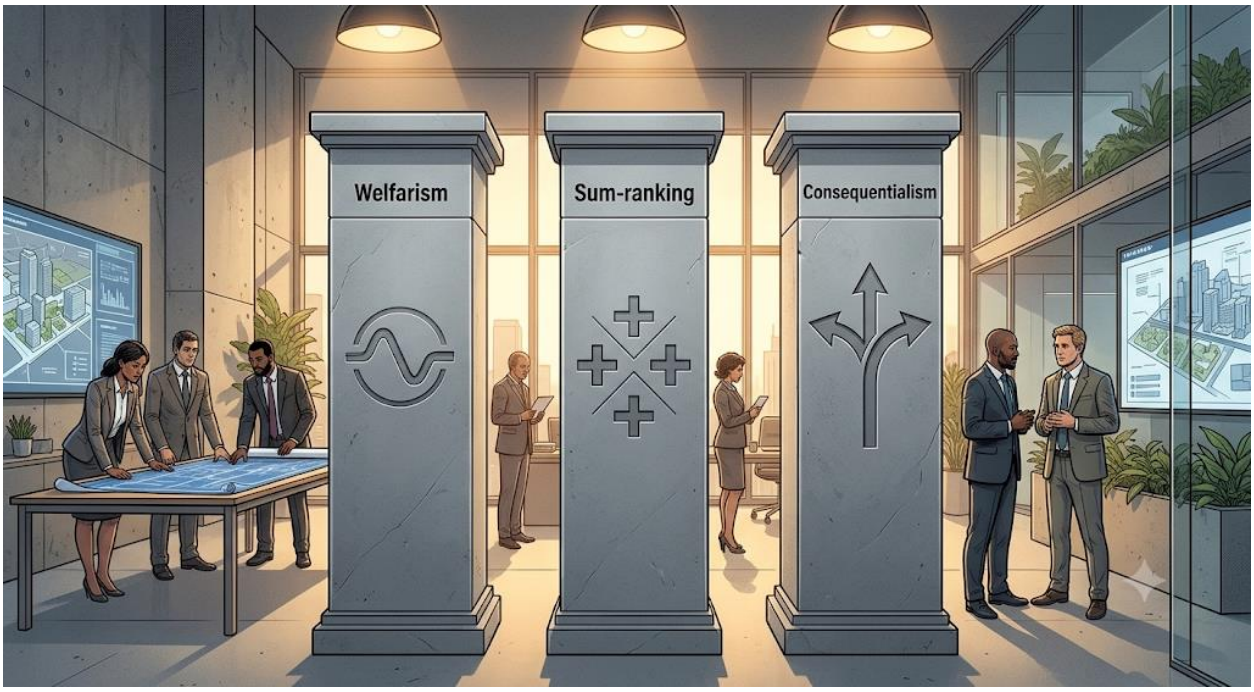

Mother: Do you want to apply?
Aarav: I don't know.
Mother: Would you go if the money were enough?
Aarav: Maybe. But then who helps here? What if I fail? Everyone will say I wasted the chance.

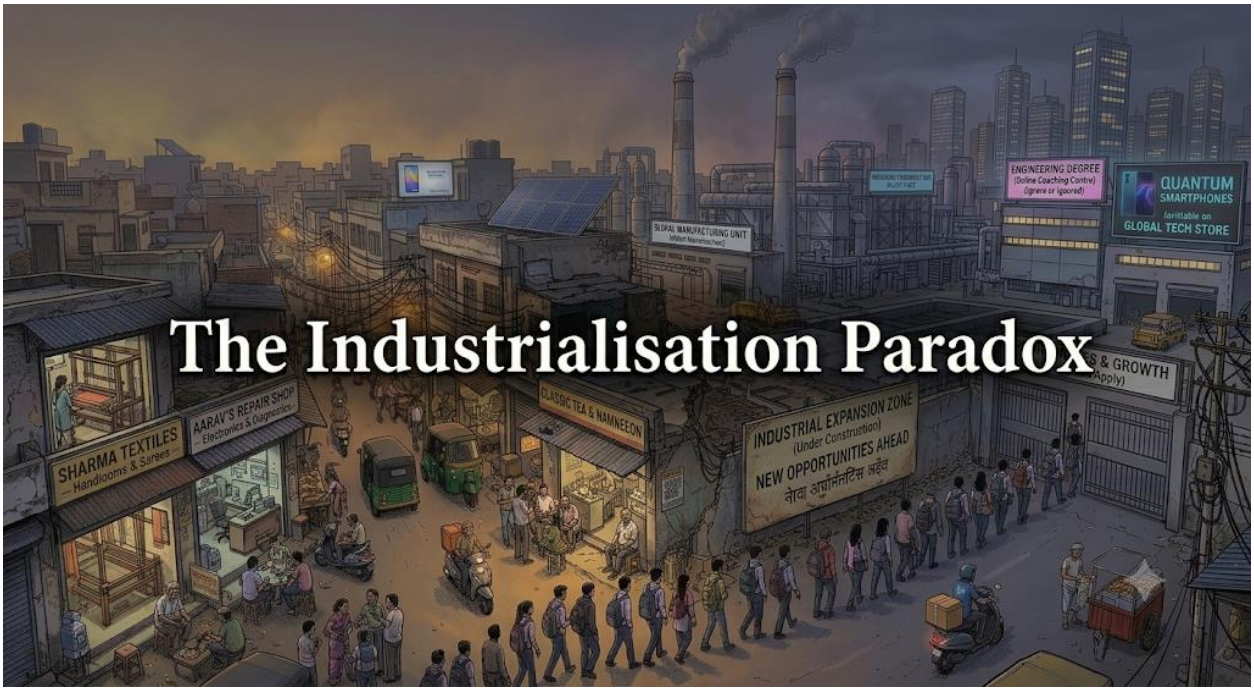

Mother: Those are real worries.
Aarav: I'm not afraid of studying. I'm tired of building my life around a possibility that might not work.


THIN RATIONALITY
Does this person act consistently with what they believe and want?
BROAD RATIONALITY
How did they come to believe and want those things?
Note.
One day, I want to study engineering.
— A Teenager's


TWENTY MONTHS IN
CAREER LAUNCHER
SUCCESS INSTITUTE
CAREER LAUNCHER
SUCCESS INSTITUTE
vivo
SHARMA ELECTRONICS
SHARMA ELECTRONICS


'What will we do with it? We need work now.'
'Our children should study, but fees and transport are the problem.'
'We're managing. Why spend money on something people may not use?'
SHARMA PROVISIONS
SMART RECHARGE KIOSK
S.T.D. HUB
TEA


Welfarism
Sum-ranking
Consequentialism


The Industrialisation Paradox
SHARMA TEXTILES
Handlooms & Sarees
AARAV'S REPAIR SHOP
Electronics & Diagnostics
CLASSIC TEA & NAMKEEN
INDUSTRIAL EXPANSION ZONE
(Under Construction)
NEW OPPORTUNITIES AHEAD
GLOBAL MANUFACTURING UNIT
ENGINEERING DEGREE
(Online Coaching Centre)
(Ignore or Ignored)
QUANTUM
SMARTPHONES
GLOBAL TECH STORE
& GROWTH